

Trustworthy AI Hackathon | Competition Rules

Building the trust layer for the AI-Agent economy

August 29 (Sat) – August 31 (Mon), 2026	
Venue	N24 Taipei Ark
Format	Two-day, one-night hackathon (8/29–8/30) + Demo Day (8/31)
Teams Selected	Up to 20 teams 3–5 members per team
Contact	hackathon2026@chain.tw

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1. About the Event

Trustworthy AI Hackathon is a hackathon on the theme of the "Trustworthy AI Agent."

When AI Agents begin to act on behalf of individuals or organizations—querying data, creating orders, submitting applications, triggering payments, or calling tools—the question is no longer merely "did the model answer correctly," but: Whom does it represent? What is it authorized to do? Which actions require human confirmation? When does authorization expire? And if something goes wrong, how can it be traced and held accountable?

This event invites teams to start from real pain points and, within two days and one night, build a demonstrable AI Agent prototype equipped with identity, authorization, action boundaries, audit logging, and expiry/revocation mechanisms.

2. Event Information

Item	Details
Event Name	Trustworthy AI Hackathon
Organizer	Taiwan Association for Blockchain Ecosystem Innovation (TABEL)
Dates	August 29 (Sat) – August 31 (Mon), 2026
Venue	N24 Taipei Ark
Format	Two-day, one-night hackathon (8/29–8/30) + Demo Day (8/31)
Registration Deadline	August 5, 2026
Preliminary Results	August 7, 2026
Teams Selected	Up to 20 teams from the preliminary review
Team Size	3–5 members per team
Eligibility	All members must be 18 or older at the time of registration
Contact	hackathon2026@chain.tw

3. Eligibility & Team Formation

1. Open to individuals aged 18 or older—students, working professionals, and industry practitioners—with an interest in AI, software development, product design, information security, digital identity, data governance, policy/regulation, or related fields.
2. Each team must consist of 3–5 members and register as a complete team.
3. Each team must designate one Team Leader as the primary contact for event notifications, document submission, on-site coordination, and prize collection.
4. Each participant may join only one team; duplicate or cross-team registration is not allowed, **and please submit the registration form before August 5.**
5. Selected teams must, within **48 hours of the preliminary announcement or the organizer's notification, have the Team Leader confirm participation via the form**, confirm the final roster, and provide any required supplementary materials. Teams that fail to complete this, do not respond, or cannot be reached may be deemed to have forfeited their place, and a waitlisted team may take the spot.
6. Once confirmed by the organizer, team members may not be changed at will; any special circumstances must be raised with the organizer in advance and approved.
7. Team names, project names, and presentation content must not contain unlawful, discriminatory, harassing, infringing, or otherwise inappropriate text or materials; the organizer may require revisions, and non-compliant teams may be disqualified.

4. Team Leader Attendance Requirements

The Team Leader must attend all designated activities of this event, including but not limited to:

- Online info session
- Pre-event workshops
- On-site Hackathon
- Demo Day
- Any required administrative, pre-event, and on-site confirmation procedures notified by the organizer

If the Team Leader cannot attend any designated activity for special reasons, they must notify the organizer by email in advance and obtain approval. Absence without prior notice or approval may, depending on the circumstances, affect the team's selection, completion, scoring, or prize eligibility.

The Team Leader may not, in principle, be changed after the registration deadline; in cases of force majeure or special circumstances, the team must submit a replacement request and obtain the organizer's approval before it takes effect. Note: as the online info session (7/20) is held before the registration deadline, if the Team Leader cannot attend live, they may watch the official recording on the event website to fulfill this requirement; the pre-event workshops, Hackathon, and Demo Day require in-person attendance.

5. Theme Directions

Topics are open to free ideation; teams are encouraged to start from real pain points and build a trustworthy AI Agent or agent-like workflow. Technology choices are free—the use of blockchain or verifiable credentials (VC) is not required. The following four directions serve as references:

Reference Direction	Common Pain Points	Core Trust Questions
Supply Chain & Trade Finance	Supplier qualification, order financing, ESG/ carbon data credibility, cross-organization documents	Does the Agent represent the buyer or the legal entity? Can it read data and draft workflows, but not execute high-risk actions on its own?
E-commerce & Third-Party Payments	AI-assisted purchasing, payment authorization, merchant trust, fraud prevention and qualification verification	Should the Agent only compare prices and create payment intent? When must the principal confirm in person?
Health & Insurance	Sensitive data, claims, consent management, underwriting and submission audit	Which data may the Agent read? Is there valid consent? How is this confirmed before submission?
Government Services	Public-sector credentials, form-filling, querying, and submission on behalf, cross-agency or cross-system mutual recognition	To what extent may the Agent act on behalf? Which actions require the principal's confirmation? How is a record kept?

Reference directions are for inspiration only; teams may propose topics in other domains, but their work must still address the identity, authorization, action boundaries, audit, and revocation of a trustworthy AI Agent.

6. Minimum Requirements for a Trustworthy AI Agent

To ensure the work embodies the core spirit of "trustworthiness" rather than being a general conversational chatbot, teams must demonstrate or explain how their AI Agent addresses the following three aspects.

Teams are free to choose their technology and implementation, provided the judges can understand the design across these three aspects.

(1) Identity & Authorization — whom it represents and what it is allowed to do

The work should clearly present whom the Agent represents, along with the scope and validity period of its permitted and prohibited actions.

(2) Action Boundaries — whether high-risk actions are controlled

The work should explain the range of tools and actions the Agent can perform, with interception, restriction, or human confirmation before high-risk or irreversible actions.

(3) Traceability & Revocability — actions are logged and permissions can be withdrawn

The work should be able to record actions and ensure that authorization genuinely expires upon its term or revocation.

Teams must be able to clearly articulate their design thinking on these three aspects in the work or its accompanying explanation.

7. Key Dates

Date	Item	Notes
7/8 (Wed)	Registration opens	Publication of rules, registration method, and contact
7/20 (Mon)	Online info session	Overview of event flow, theme directions, registration and selection
8/5 (Wed)	Registration closes	Registration closed and materials compiled
8/7 (Fri)	Preliminary results announced	Notification of selected, waitlisted, and non-selected teams
8/9 (Sun)	Confirmation deadline	Complete participation confirmation, final roster, and required materials
8/15 (Sat)	Pre-event Workshop #1 (online)	Trustworthy AI Agent and digital-credential tool walkthrough
8/22 (Sat)	Pre-event Workshop #2 (in person)	Industry pain points and POC topic refinement
8/29 (Sat)–8/30 (Sun)	Hackathon	Two-day, one-night development, mentor support, and official submission
8/31 (Mon)	Demo Day	Final presentations, judging, awards, and networking

All times are subject to the organizer's latest announcements.

8. Attendance Requirements

1. The Team Leader must attend all designated activities and any necessary procedures notified by the organizer.
2. Other members are not required to attend all pre-event workshops, but each team is strongly encouraged to send a representative to understand the rules, technical directions, and demo requirements.
3. During the Hackathon (8/29–8/30), teams must maintain sufficient on-site presence to complete their work and undergo the organizer's checks.

4. Demo Day (8/31) is the finals and awards day; the Team Leader must be present, and the presentation may be delivered by the Team Leader or a designated member. Prize winners must additionally have all members on the final roster present—see Section 9.
5. Winning teams must, in principle, have all members on the final confirmed roster attend Demo Day; teams unable to have all members present will be handled per Section 9.

9. Demo Day & Prize Eligibility

Demo Day is the event's finals and awards process. All selected teams must complete their presentation and demonstration as arranged by the organizer.

To receive a prize, a winning team must meet all of the following:

1. Completed the official submission required by the organizer.
2. Completed its demonstration on Demo Day.
3. All members on the team's final confirmed roster attended Demo Day.
4. No violation of the event rules, data-use policy, intellectual property rules, or code of conduct.

If a winning team cannot have all members present on Demo Day, the organizer may, at its discretion, withhold, defer, adjust, or cancel that team's prize. "All members" refers to the final team roster confirmed by the organizer after selection.

10. Registration & Required Materials

Registration is free and online, completed by the Team Leader on behalf of the complete team; each team submits only once.

Three registration steps

1. During the registration period, fill in team and project information on the official registration form (the registration link is subject to official announcements and the event website).
2. Prepare and upload a team background file; see the table below for contents.
3. Confirm the consent items and submit; the system will record the contact email for follow-up notifications.

Required for registration (to be entered in the form):

Item	Description
Team background	Team name, members and role division, affiliation, relevant experience
Pain point	The core pain point you want to solve, including who is affected and the current situation
Proposed solution	An initial concept for a trustworthy AI Agent or agent-like workflow addressing the pain point
Portfolio link (optional)	GitHub, Demo, Figma, Notion, video, or existing work links
Consent items	Agreement to the rules, personal-data use, one-team-per-person, and truthfulness of information

After submission, the organizer may conduct an eligibility review. If registration materials are incomplete, untrue, duplicated, do not meet team-size requirements, or lack required consents, the organizer may cancel the registration or selection.

11. Submission Requirements

The work must be a functioning prototype (a small-scope POC with test data is acceptable) that can demonstrate the operation of the six trust mechanisms live at the demo; slide-only decks, mockups, or non-runnable concept demonstrations do not meet the submission or scoring requirements.

Selected teams must complete the following submissions by 23:59 on 8/30 (Sun):

1. A code repository link
2. The presentation deck used on Demo Day, including a one-page "Governance / Trust Design Note"
3. A demo link or demonstration video
4. A README (including how to run, how to demonstrate, and third-party package disclosure)

Missing items, late submission, content that cannot be opened, inability to demonstrate the prototype, or failure to disclose required third-party materials may affect scoring, completion, or prize eligibility.

Only teams that complete all of the above submissions and demonstrate on Demo Day are considered to have completed the competition.

The submission platform and exact deadline are subject to the organizer's latest announcements.

12. Evaluation

The event has two stages: preliminary and final.

Preliminary: Written Review of Registration Materials

The organizer will conduct an eligibility and written review based on registration materials, selecting 20 teams for the main event. Results will be announced on 8/7 by email and on the event website; selected, waitlisted, and non-selected teams will each be notified individually.

Criterion	Weight	Focus
Topic relevance	50%	Whether it addresses the identity, authorization, verification, privacy, security, or accountability of a trustworthy AI Agent.
Feasibility	30%	Whether a demonstrable prototype can be completed within two days; whether the technical approach, data, and API needs are reasonable.
Team capability	20%	Whether the team has development, product, presentation, or domain capability; whether roles are clearly divided.

If a selected team fails to confirm in time, has non-matching information, withdraws, or violates the rules, the organizer may fill the spot from the waitlist.

Final: On-Site Scoring on Demo Day

The finals take place on Demo Day, where selected teams present and demo their work live. Each team presents for about 5 minutes, with time reserved for judges' questions (exact duration and whether Q&A is held are subject to on-site announcement).

Criterion	Weight	Focus
Industry scenario fit	35%	Whether it genuinely solves the chosen pain point; whether the target users and real-world value are clear.
	25%	

Criterion	Weight	Focus
Feasibility of a trustworthy AI Agent		Whether trust mechanisms—principal, authorization scope, action control, audit, and expiry/revocation—are complete and feasible.
Presentation & Demo	25%	Whether the prototype actually works; whether the presentation, live demo, and Q&A are clear, credible, and convincing.
Insight & creativity	15%	Whether the observation of the pain point is deep; whether the solution shows originality and ingenuity.

In case of a tie, priority goes first to "Industry scenario fit," then to "Feasibility of a trustworthy AI Agent"; if necessary, the judging panel will decide by discussion.

13. Prizes

The main cash prize pool starts at USD 12,000 and may increase with sponsorship. Actual special awards, hardware prizes, development resources, and disbursement methods are subject to official announcement.

Prize	Number	Amount
Champion	1 team	USD 5,000
First Runner-up	2 teams	USD 2,000 each
Second Runner-up	3 teams	USD 1,000 each

The organizer may, based on the standard of submissions, judging results, and sponsorship, add special awards, adjust prize content, or reserve the right to leave prizes unawarded. Prize disbursement, taxes, and foreign-currency settlement will follow the organizer's announcements and applicable laws.

14. Intellectual Property & Data Use

1. Intellectual property in the work belongs, in principle, to the participating team.
2. Teams must ensure that all submitted proposals, code, model configurations, data, text and images, presentations, audio/video, demos, and other materials are original to the team, properly licensed, or public content usable under law.
3. If third-party APIs, models, datasets, open-source packages, existing code, or external materials are used, teams must comply with their licenses and disclose them upon submission.
4. Unauthorized, unsourced, unlawfully obtained, or sensitive personal data must not be used. For scenarios involving healthcare, finance, government, or other sensitive contexts, anonymized, synthetic, or test data should be used.
5. If a work or submission involves infringement, illegality, license violation, data leakage, or other third-party disputes, the team is solely responsible and bears the related legal liability; the organizer may cancel its participation, completion, or prize eligibility.
6. Teams agree that the organizer and partners may use the team name, project name, public summary, presentation screenshots, demonstration content, and on-site photos and videos for event documentation, results publication, media coverage, results reports, and non-commercial promotion.

15. Personal Data & Image Use

1. Personal data collected by the organizer is used only for this event's registration, contact, eligibility review, event operations, on-site management, certificate/credential issuance, results documentation, and necessary administration.
2. Participants may, under applicable personal-data-protection laws, request the organizer to inquire, review, obtain copies of, supplement, correct, cease the collection/processing/use of, or delete their data.
3. Photography, recording, live-streaming, or results documentation may take place on site, and such images may be used for event documentation, results publication, and non-commercial promotion.
4. For any special image requirements, participants should proactively notify the organizer before the event.

16. Safety & Overnight Stay

1. Overnight arrangements are provided during the event (8/29–8/30); exact capacity, zoning, and management are subject to the organizer's notification.
2. During the overnight stay, entrance/exit control and night management will be in place; participants must follow the N24 Taipei Ark venue rules and staff instructions.
3. Please keep personal valuables yourself; the organizer is not responsible for safekeeping.
4. Dangerous or unlawful behavior, harassment, discrimination, violence, damage to equipment, or interference with other teams' work is prohibited on site.
5. Participants must bring their own laptops and personal development devices; the organizer provides internet, power, and meals during the event, with other equipment subject to on-site announcement.

17. Disqualification & Violations

The organizer may cancel a team's registration, selection, participation, completion, or prize eligibility in any of the following cases:

1. False registration information, concealment of important information, or impersonation.
2. Team size not meeting requirements, or members participating in multiple teams.
3. Changing members after confirmation without the organizer's approval.
4. The Team Leader failing to attend designated activities without prior approval.
5. Failure to complete required submissions, late submission, inability to demonstrate the work, or inability to prove it is the team's own work.
6. Plagiarism, cheating, or infringement of others' intellectual property, trade secrets, personal data, or other rights.
7. Use of unauthorized, unlawful, real sensitive, or unsourced data.
8. Malicious attacks on the event systems, venue equipment, organizer systems, or other teams' work.
9. Harassment, discrimination, violence, dangerous behavior, or other serious misconduct.
10. Violation of the organizer's announced event rules or other material matters.

In cases of serious violation, the organizer may reclaim awarded prizes, certificates, credentials, resources, or other benefits.

18. Organizer's Rights

1. The organizer may adjust the event flow, schedule, rules, judging method, prize content, and related arrangements in light of registration status, venue, sponsorship, weather, safety, technical, or force-majeure factors.
2. The organizer reserves the final right of interpretation and decision over the rules, eligibility determination, judging process, results, prize disbursement, and violation handling.
3. Matters not covered by these rules may be supplemented by the organizer's announcements, and the latest announcement prevails.

19. Contact

For questions about registration, rules, eligibility, event flow, or anything else, please contact:

hackathon2026@chain.tw

Event website: <https://hackathon-net.vercel.app/>